



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*lokair vilokyate cauro gate svalpe 'pi vastuni |
sarvasvaharam ātmānaṃ manāk paśyanti no jaḍāḥ || 6 |
taśyāmāpi kadā yena kāyadurgasamāśritaḥ | [tan nāmāpi?]
ajñānachāḍitaḥ svātmā nirīkṣyo yogibhiḥ sadā || 7 |
ātmaiva suprasannotra sugatiḥ parikīrtatā |
aprasannaḥ punar ayaṃ durgatiḥ syād asaṃśayam || 8 |*

— Yogapradīpa, Chapter 1, Verses 6-8

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Yogapradīpa paint a stark picture of our misplaced priorities. We are quick to notice when a small, external object is missing, like a misplaced possession. We become detectives, acutely aware of the perceived loss. Yet, these verses gently chide us: how often do you, in your daily life, notice the grand larceny occurring within? The true thief, the one robbing you of your inherent peace and joy, is your own ignorance – your forgetfulness of your true Self.

This Self, the ātman, resides within the fortress of your body, obscured by the shadows of ignorance (ajñāna). It's easy to become distracted by the demands of the external world, the constant barrage of information and stimulation. This constant noise acts as a veil, preventing you from seeing the radiant truth of your own being. The yogis, however, are urged to constantly look inwards, to penetrate this veil through practices like meditation and self-reflection. They seek to uncover that which is always present, yet often overlooked.

The text then presents a compelling choice: a path of joy (suprasannotra sugatiḥ) or a path of suffering (aprasannaḥ punar ayaṃ durgatiḥ). Your own inner state determines your destiny. When you are aligned with your true Self, content and at peace, you experience a life of ease and fulfillment. However, when you are disconnected, driven by ego and attachment, you inevitably face hardship and dissatisfaction. This isn't a judgment from an external source, but a natural consequence of living out of harmony with your true nature.

In modern life, bombarded with distractions and societal pressures, this message is more relevant than ever. We are encouraged to seek happiness externally, in possessions, relationships, and achievements. The Yogapradīpa reminds you that the source of true happiness lies within. By turning your attention inward, cultivating self-awareness, and stripping away the layers of ignorance, you can reclaim your inherent joy and navigate life with greater clarity and peace. Don't let the thief of ignorance steal your most precious possession: your own Self.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If you were to dedicate just five minutes to uncovering your true Self today, what practice would best serve you in that endeavor?